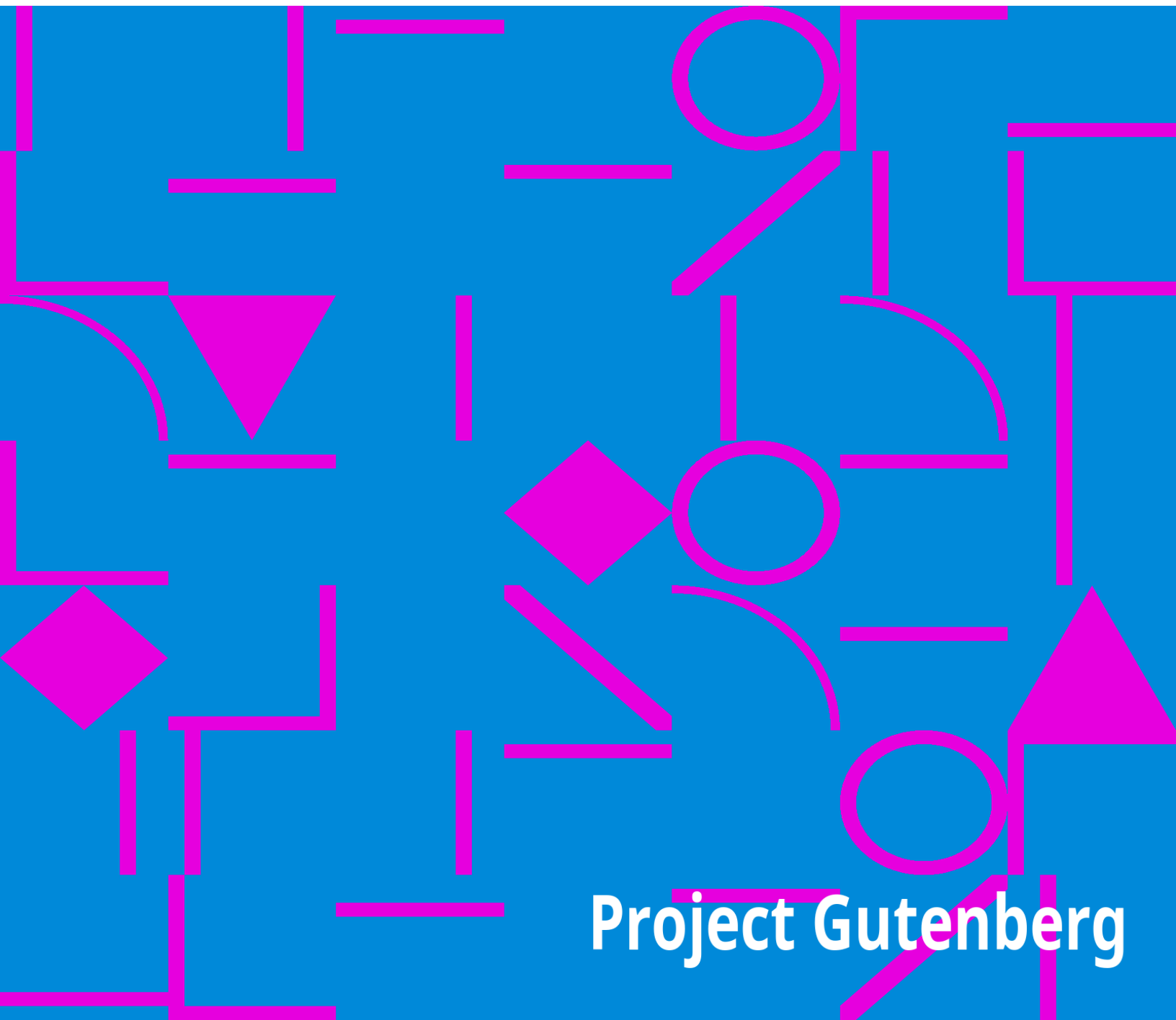


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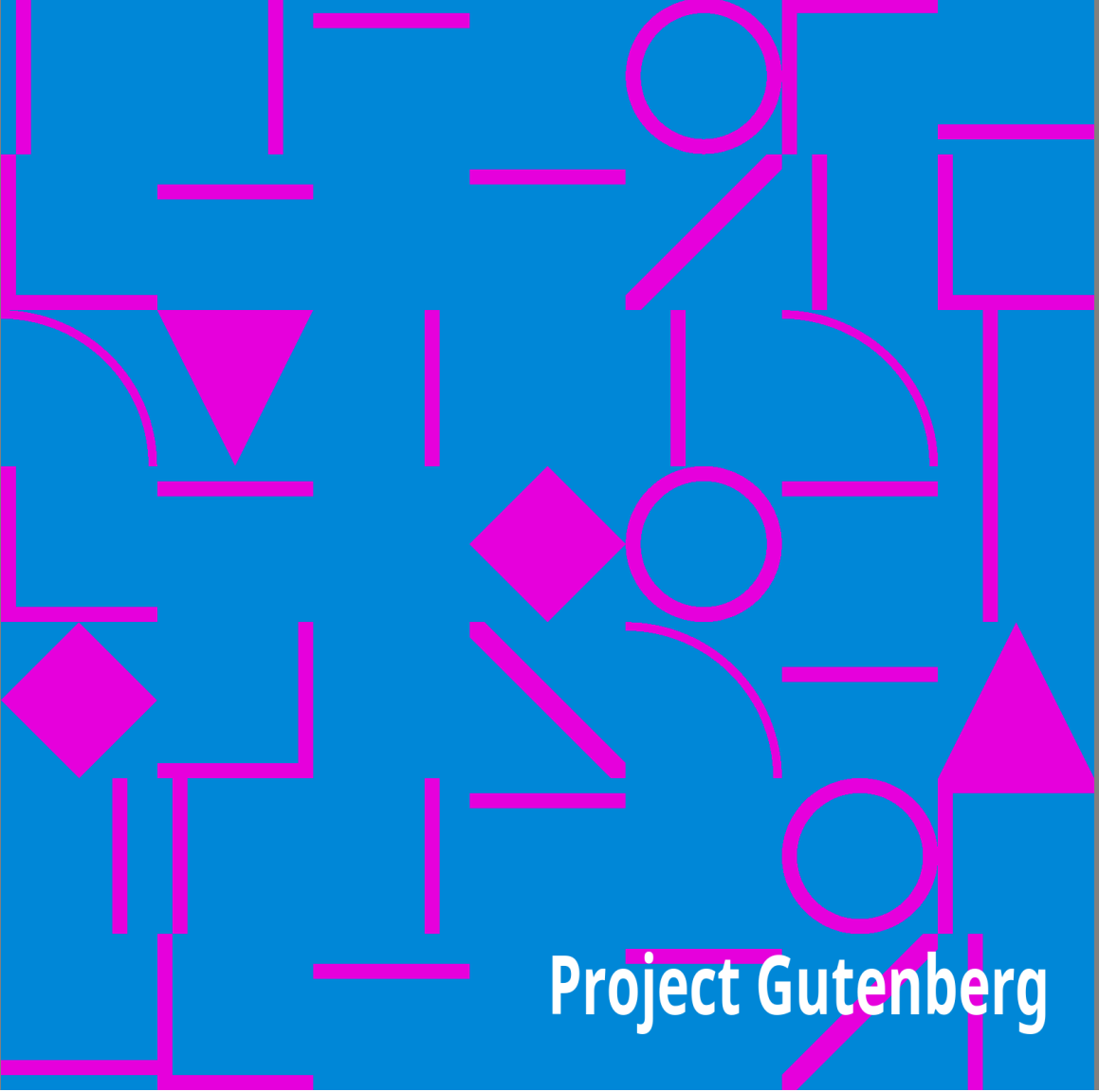
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Book 33 Micah 001:001 The word of Yahweh that came to Micah the Morashtite in the days of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, which he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem. 001:002 Hear, you peoples, all of you. Listen, O earth, and all that is therein: and let the Lord Yahweh be witness against you, the Lord from his holy temple. 001:003 For, behold, Yahweh comes forth out of

his place, and will come down and tread on the high places of the earth. 001:004 The mountains melt under him, and the valleys split apart, like wax before the fire, like waters that are poured down a steep place. 001:005 "All this is for the disobedience of Jacob, and for the sins of the house of Israel. What is the disobedience of Jacob? Isn't it Samaria? And what are the high places of Judah? Aren't they Jerusalem? 001:006 Therefore I will make Samaria like a rubble heap of the field, like places for planting vineyards; and I will pour down its stones into the valley, and I will uncover its foundations.

001:007 All her idols will be beaten to pieces, and all her temple gifts will be burned with fire, and all her images I will destroy; for of the hire of a prostitute has she gathered them, and to the hire of a prostitute shall they return." 001:008 For this I will lament and wail; I will go stripped and naked; I will howl like the jackals, and moan like the daughters of owls. 001:009 For her wounds are incurable; for it has come even to Judah. It reaches to the gate of my people, even to Jerusalem. 001:010 Don't tell it in Gath. Don't weep at all. At Beth Ophrah{Beth Ophrah means literally "House of Dust."} I have

**rolled myself in the dust. 001:011
Pass on, inhabitant of Shaphir, in
nakedness and shame. The
inhabitant of Zaanah won't come
out. The wailing of Beth Ezel will
take from you his protection.**

**001:012 For the inhabitant of
Maroth waits anxiously for good,
because evil has come down from
Yahweh to the gate of Jerusalem.**

**001:013 Harness the chariot to the
swift steed, inhabitant of Lachish.
She was the beginning of sin to the
daughter of Zion; For the
transgressions of Israel were found
in you. 001:014 Therefore you will
give a parting gift to Moresheth
Gath. The houses of Achzib will be**

**a deceitful thing to the kings of
Israel. 001:015 I will yet bring to
you, inhabitant of Mareshah. He
who is the glory of Israel will come
to Adullam. 001:016 Shave your
heads, and cut off your hair for the
children of your delight. Enlarge
your baldness like the vulture; for
they have gone into captivity from
you! 002:001 Woe to those who
devise iniquity and work evil on
their beds! When the morning is
light, they practice it, because it is
in the power of their hand. 002:002
They covet fields, and seize them;
and houses, and take them away:
and they oppress a man and his
house, even a man and his heritage.**

**002:003 Therefore thus says
Yahweh: "Behold, I am planning
against these people a disaster,
from which you will not remove
your necks, neither will you walk
haughtily; for it is an evil time.**

**002:004 In that day they will take
up a parable against you, and
lament with a doleful lamentation,
saying, 'We are utterly ruined! My
people's possession is divided up.
Indeed he takes it from me and
assigns our fields to traitors!'"**

**002:005 Therefore you will have no
one who divides the land by lot in
the assembly of Yahweh. 002:006**

"Don't prophesy!" They prophesy.

"Don't prophesy about these

things. Disgrace won't overtake us." 002:007 Shall it be said, O house of Jacob: "Is the Spirit of Yahweh angry? Are these his doings? Don't my words do good to him who walks blamelessly?"

002:008 But lately my people have risen up as an enemy. You strip the robe and clothing from those who pass by without a care, returning from battle. 002:009 You drive the women of my people out from their pleasant houses; from their young children you take away my blessing forever. 002:010 Arise, and depart! For this is not your resting place, because of uncleanness that destroys, even with a grievous

destruction. 002:011 If a man walking in a spirit of falsehood lies: "I will prophesy to you of wine and of strong drink;" he would be the prophet of this people. 002:012 I will surely assemble, Jacob, all of you; I will surely gather the remnant of Israel; I will put them together as the sheep of Bozrah, as a flock in the midst of their pasture; they will swarm with people. 002:013 He who breaks open the way goes up before them. They break through the gate, and go out. And their king passes on before them, with Yahweh at their head. 003:001 I said, "Please listen, you heads of Jacob, and rulers of

**the house of Israel: Isn't it for you
to know justice? 003:002 You who
hate the good, and love the evil;
who tear off their skin, and their
flesh from off their bones; 003:003
who also eat the flesh of my people,
and flay their skin from off them,
and break their bones, and chop
them in pieces, as for the pot, and
as flesh within the caldron. 003:004
Then they will cry to Yahweh, but
he will not answer them. Yes, he
will hide his face from them at that
time, because they made their
deeds evil." 003:005 Thus says
Yahweh concerning the prophets
who lead my people astray; for
those who feed their teeth, they**

proclaim, "Peace!" and whoever doesn't provide for their mouths, they prepare war against him:

003:006 "Therefore night is over you, with no vision, and it is dark to you, that you may not divine; and the sun will go down on the prophets, and the day will be black over them. 003:007 The seers shall be disappointed, and the diviners confounded. Yes, they shall all cover their lips; for there is no answer from God." 003:008 But as for me, I am full of power by the Spirit of Yahweh, and of judgment, and of might, to declare to Jacob his disobedience, and to Israel his sin. 003:009 Please listen to this,

**you heads of the house of Jacob,
and rulers of the house of Israel,
who abhor justice, and pervert all
equity. 003:010 They build up Zion
with blood, and Jerusalem with
iniquity. 003:011 Her leaders judge
for bribes, and her priests teach for
a price, and her prophets of it tell
fortunes for money: yet they lean
on Yahweh, and say, "Isn't Yahweh
in the midst of us? No disaster will
come on us." 003:012 Therefore
Zion for your sake will be plowed
like a field, and Jerusalem will
become heaps of rubble, and the
mountain of the temple like the
high places of a forest. 004:001 But
in the latter days, it will happen**

that the mountain of Yahweh's temple will be established on the top of the mountains, and it will be exalted above the hills; and peoples will stream to it. 004:002 Many nations will go and say, "Come, and let us go up to the mountain of Yahweh, and to the house of the God of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths." For out of Zion will go forth the law, and the word of Yahweh from Jerusalem; 004:003 and he will judge between many peoples, and will decide concerning strong nations afar off. They will beat their swords into plowshares, and their spears into pruning

**hooks. Nation will not lift up sword
against nation, neither will they
learn war any more. 004:004 But
they will sit every man under his
vine and under his fig tree; and no
one will make them afraid: For the
mouth of Yahweh of Armies has
spoken. 004:005 Indeed all the
nations may walk in the name of
their gods; but we will walk in the
name of Yahweh our God forever
and ever. 004:006 "In that day,"
says Yahweh, "I will assemble that
which is lame, and I will gather
that which is driven away, and that
which I have afflicted; 004:007 and
I will make that which was lame a
remnant, and that which was cast**

far off a strong nation: and Yahweh will reign over them on Mount Zion from then on, even forever."

004:008 You, tower of the flock, the hill of the daughter of Zion, to you it will come, yes, the former dominion will come, the kingdom of the daughter of Jerusalem.

004:009 Now why do you cry out aloud? Is there no king in you? Has your counselor perished, that pains have taken hold of you as of a woman in travail? 004:010 Be in pain, and labor to bring forth, daughter of Zion, like a woman in travail; for now you will go forth out of the city, and will dwell in the field, and will come even to

**Babylon. There you will be rescued.
There Yahweh will redeem you
from the hand of your enemies.**

**004:011 Now many nations have
assembled against you, that say,
"Let her be defiled, and let our eye
gloat over Zion." 004:012 But they
don't know the thoughts of
Yahweh, neither do they
understand his counsel; for he has
gathered them like the sheaves to
the threshing floor. 004:013 Arise
and thresh, daughter of Zion; for I
will make your horn iron, and I will
make your hoofs brass; and you
will beat in pieces many peoples:
and I will devote their gain to
Yahweh, and their substance to the**

**Lord of the whole earth. 005:001
Now you shall gather yourself in
troops, daughter of troops. He has
laid siege against us. They will
strike the judge of Israel with a rod
on the cheek. 005:002 But you,
Bethlehem Ephrathah, being small
among the clans of Judah, out of
you one will come forth to me that
is to be ruler in Israel; whose
goings forth are from of old, from
everlasting. 005:003 Therefore he
will abandon them until the time
that she who is in labor gives birth.
Then the rest of his brothers will
return to the children of Israel.
005:004 He shall stand, and shall
shepherd in the strength of**

Yahweh, in the majesty of the name of Yahweh his God: and they will live, for then he will be great to the ends of the earth. 005:005 He will be our peace when Assyria invades our land, and when he marches through our fortresses, then we will raise against him seven shepherds, and eight leaders of men. 005:006 They will rule the land of Assyria with the sword, and the land of Nimrod in its gates. He will deliver us from the Assyrian, when he invades our land, and when he marches within our border. 005:007 The remnant of Jacob will be in the midst of many peoples, like dew from Yahweh, like showers on the

**grass, that don't wait for man, nor
wait for the sons of men. 005:008**

**The remnant of Jacob will be
among the nations, in the midst of
many peoples, like a lion among the
animals of the forest, like a young
lion among the flocks of sheep;
who, if he goes through, treads
down and tears in pieces, and there
is no one to deliver. 005:009 Let
your hand be lifted up above your
adversaries, and let all of your
enemies be cut off. 005:010 "It will
happen in that day," says Yahweh,
"That I will cut off your horses out
of the midst of you, and will destroy
your chariots. 005:011 I will cut off
the cities of your land, and will tear**

**down all your strongholds. 005:012
I will destroy witchcraft from your
hand; and you shall have no
soothsayers. 005:013 I will cut off
your engraved images and your
pillars out of your midst; and you
shall no more worship the work of
your hands. 005:014 I will uproot
your Asherim out of your midst;
and I will destroy your cities.
005:015 I will execute vengeance in
anger, and wrath on the nations
that didn't listen." 006:001 Listen
now to what Yahweh says: "Arise,
plead your case before the
mountains, and let the hills hear
what you have to say. 006:002 Hear,
you mountains, Yahweh's**

**controversy, and you enduring
foundations of the earth; for
Yahweh has a controversy with his
people, and he will contend with
Israel. 006:003 My people, what
have I done to you? How have I
burdened you? Answer me!**

**006:004 For I brought you up out
of the land of Egypt, and redeemed
you out of the house of bondage. I
sent before you Moses, Aaron, and
Miriam. 006:005 My people,
remember now what Balak king of
Moab devised, and what Balaam
the son of Beor answered him from
Shittim to Gilgal, that you may
know the righteous acts of
Yahweh." 006:006 How shall I**

**come before Yahweh, and bow
myself before the exalted God?
Shall I come before him with burnt
offerings, with calves a year old?
006:007 Will Yahweh be pleased
with thousands of rams? With tens
of thousands of rivers of oil? Shall I
give my firstborn for my
disobedience? The fruit of my body
for the sin of my soul? 006:008 He
has shown you, O man, what is
good. What does Yahweh require of
you, but to act justly, to love mercy,
and to walk humbly with your
God? 006:009 Yahweh's voice calls
to the city, and wisdom sees your
name: "Listen to the rod, and he
who appointed it. 006:010 Are there**

yet treasures of wickedness in the house of the wicked, and a short ephah{An ephah is a measure of volume, and a short ephah is made smaller than a full ephah for the purpose of cheating customers.}

that is accursed? 006:011 Shall I be pure with dishonest scales, and with a bag of deceitful weights?

006:012 Her rich men are full of violence, her inhabitants speak lies, and their tongue is deceitful in their speech. 006:013 Therefore I also

have struck you with a grievous wound. I have made you desolate because of your sins. 006:014 You shall eat, but not be satisfied. Your humiliation will be in your midst.

You will store up, but not save; and that which you save I will give up to the sword. 006:015 You will sow, but won't reap. You will tread the olives, but won't anoint yourself with oil; and crush grapes, but won't drink the wine. 006:016 For the statutes of Omri are kept, and all the works of the house of Ahab. You walk in their counsels, that I may make you a ruin, and her inhabitants a hissing; And you will bear the reproach of my people." 007:001 Misery is mine! Indeed, I am like one who gathers the summer fruits, as gleanings of the vineyard: There is no cluster of grapes to eat. My soul desires to eat

the early fig. 007:002 The godly man has perished out of the earth, and there is no one upright among men. They all lie in wait for blood; every man hunts his brother with a net. 007:003 Their hands are on that which is evil to do it diligently. The ruler and judge ask for a bribe; and the powerful man dictates the evil desire of his soul. Thus they conspire together. 007:004 The best of them is like a brier. The most upright is worse than a thorn hedge. The day of your watchmen, even your visitation, has come; now is the time of their confusion. 007:005 Don't trust in a neighbor. Don't put

confidence in a friend. With the woman lying in your embrace, be careful of the words of your mouth!

007:006 For the son dishonors the father, the daughter rises up against her mother, the daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law; a man's enemies are the men of his own house. 007:007 But as for me, I will look to Yahweh. I will wait for the God of my salvation. My God will hear me. 007:008 Don't rejoice against me, my enemy. When I fall, I will arise. When I sit in darkness, Yahweh will be a light to me.

007:009 I will bear the indignation of Yahweh, because I have sinned against him, until he pleads my

case, and executes judgment for me. He will bring me forth to the light. I will see his righteousness. 007:010 Then my enemy will see it, and shame will cover her who said to me, where is Yahweh your God? Then my enemy will see me and will cover her shame. Now she will be trodden down like the mire of the streets. 007:011 A day to build your walls—In that day, he will extend your boundary. 007:012 In that day they will come to you from Assyria and the cities of Egypt, and from Egypt even to the River, and from sea to sea, and mountain to mountain. 007:013 Yet the land will be desolate because of those who

dwell therein, for the fruit of their doings. 007:014 Shepherd your people with your staff, the flock of your heritage, who dwell by themselves in a forest, in the midst of fertile pasture land, let them feed; in Bashan and Gilead, as in the days of old. 007:015 "As in the days of your coming forth out of the land of Egypt, I will show them marvelous things." 007:016 The nations will see and be ashamed of all their might. They will lay their hand on their mouth. Their ears will be deaf. 007:017 They will lick the dust like a serpent. Like crawling things of the earth they shall come trembling out of their

**dens. They will come with fear to
Yahweh our God, and will be afraid
because of you. 007:018 Who is a
God like you, who pardons iniquity,
and passes over the disobedience of
the remnant of his heritage? He
doesn't retain his anger forever,
because he delights in loving
kindness. 007:019 He will again
have compassion on us. He will
tread our iniquities under foot; and
you will cast all their sins into the
depths of the sea. 007:020 You will
give truth to Jacob, and mercy to
Abraham, as you have sworn to our
fathers from the days of old.**

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